

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Emergency water storage

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Store at least one gallon of water per person per day for three days; aim for two weeks if practical. Allow more for heat, illness, pregnancy and pets. Use commercially bottled water or clean food-grade containers, and keep it cool and away from chemicals.

Do now.

☐**Calculate needs**

01

Count people and days and add water for pets and extra needs.

☐**Choose containers**

02

Use commercially bottled water or food-grade containers intended for water.

☐**Label and store**

03

Mark fill dates and store away from sunlight, fuel and cleaning products.

☐**Rotate supplies**

04

Follow bottled-water dates and replace self-filled stored water every six months.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Calculate the household quantity on paper and store smaller containers if lifting a large container is difficult. Keep one portable supply ready. Divide storage between safe places so damage to one container does not lose all the household water.

Watch for.

Do not reuse containers that held toxic substances, even after washing.

People & practical needs.

Build the plan around the least mobile person and the shortest critical supply. Try carrying the kit, opening containers and using the light in the dark

Next decision.

Learn the local advisory system. Plan how to transport water if distribution sites open.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Emergency water storage · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/water-storage/>